that spoken Malayalam, including many terms and usages, change from district to district, making these incomprehensible to those from other parts of even that small state. Similar language differences can be seen across caste and religious communities. Contemporary Malayalam cinema perhaps has the best explorations of such internal differentiation in the language.

So, who amongst this densely populated state with its myriad internal differences would refer to India as Bharat or Bharatham? Indeed, to whom would this even be of significance? As a Malayalam speaker who has lived and worked in Kerala, off and on, I would say that most people of the state would be more likely to use the term 'Indiakkar' (people of India) than 'Bharathiyar'. The latter is restricted to stiff formal usage.

Keralites have travelled outside the state, and country, for work for a very long time, a trend that has been on the



By **KANCHA ILAIAH SHEPHERD**

BHARAT, SYMBOL OF **BRUTE POWER**

'INDIA', AN INCLUSIVE TERM, EMBODIES OUR SOCIAL, SPIRITUAL AND CIVILISATIONAL ROOTS. 'BHARAT' HAS DRUNK DEEPLY OF SANATAN DHARMA'S BRUTAL BREW OF CASTE, RACE AND MASCULINITY. DALITS/ ADIVASIS MUST OPPOSE ITS ADOPTION

After opposition parties adopted the acronym INDIA (Indian National Developmental Inclusive Alliance), Prime Minister Narendra Modi and other BJP leaders attacked it as an indication of the Opposition's colonial mindset. Followed by RSS sarsanghchalak Mohan Bhagwat, they asked people to use "Bharat instead of India" to instil a sense of "national pride". Thus started the name-change game plan of the RSS/ BJP. They are now trying to project it as part of their decolonisation agenda. Dr B.R. Ambedkar's final adoption of the name 'India' in the Preamble of the Constitution—"We the people of India"—has priority over the way it was used in Article 1: "India, that is Bharat". Why did he prioritise India over Bharat as the name of the country, though both were used in the Constitution?

The oppressed castes of India were starting to be conscious of their rights by the time the Constitution was adopted in 1950. The name Bharat stemmed from the Sanatan heritage in post-Vedic times and has caste/ racial connotations. The name of the subcontinent, India, is more acceptable as it mirrors our most ancient advancement. It unites all under a common identity—Dravidian, Aryan and Mongoloid races and the teeming agrarian productive masses. Most such productive masses exist now in social categories like Shudra (OBC), Dalit and Adivasis. The name of this country must reflect their contribution too. 'Bharat' has no such civilisational significance; it does not encompass the long-existing productive civilisation of this subcontinent.

The name India indicates the subcontinent's social, spiritual, cultural and civilisational roots, not just of the present land